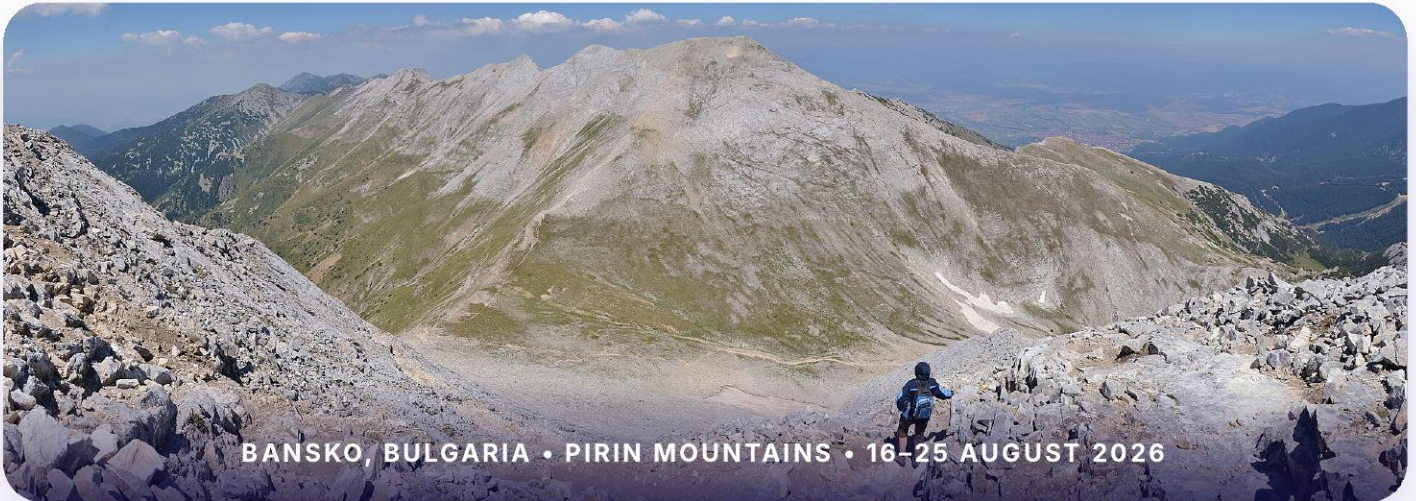


Welcome Pack

All you need to know before the project



Surf Smart, Stay Safe: Online Protection for Youth

Erasmus+ KA152 Youth Exchange • forum JUGEND! e.V. • Form ID: KA152-YOU-6FC2B5EB



How to get to Royal Bansko

Accommodation: Royal Bansko Family Apart Hotel

Website: royalbansko.bg

Address: [ul. Kosherina, 2770 Bansko, Bulgaria](#)

Royal Bansko is located in the town of Bansko, at the foot of the Pirin Mountains — surrounded by mountain scenery and within walking distance of local restaurants, shops and the town centre.



Getting to Bansko by bus

Most participants will arrive at **Sofia Central Bus Station** (Tsentralna Avtogara). From there, take a direct bus to Bansko — the journey takes about **2.5–3 hours**.

- 1 At Sofia Central Bus Station, buy a ticket at the counter or online at obilet.com.
- 2 Board a direct bus to **Bansko** (several departures daily).

- 3 Arrive at **Bansko Bus Station** (Автогара Банско).
- 4 Take a taxi directly to **Royal Bansko** (about 5 minutes).

 **Keep your taxi receipt!** The taxi fare from the bus station to the hotel is reimbursable — ask the driver for a receipt and keep it safe.

If arriving by plane (Sofia Airport)

- 1 From Sofia Airport, take the **Metro** to **Serdika station** (city centre).
- 2 Walk or take a taxi to **Sofia Central Bus Station** (about 10 min).
- 3 Follow the bus steps above to reach Bansko.

 **Useful tip:** Check bus schedules at obilet.com or use **Google Maps** for real-time transit directions.

Arrival & check-in

On arrival, go directly to the **reception desk** to complete your registration. The organisers will be there to welcome you and help with room assignments.

Accommodation & Surroundings

Hotel spa & pool

Royal Bansko has a **spa & wellness centre** with an **indoor swimming pool**, sauna and outdoor jacuzzis, available for the group during free time. Bring **flip-flops** and a **swimming suit** so you can enjoy the facilities!

 **Good to know:** **Towels are provided** by the hotel. **Bathrobes for the spa** can be rented for the whole stay for just **€2**. Tap water is safe to drink — it comes **directly from the Pirin Mountain springs** — so bring a **reusable bottle & cup** and refill freely!

Nearby essentials

Pharmacy

Apteka Bansko (5 min walk)

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Currency exchange

Exchange bureau, town centre

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Supermarket (T-Market)

T-Market Bansko (10 min walk)

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Supermarket (Billa)

Billa Bansko (10 min walk)

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Places to visit nearby

Pulse Therme (Banya)

The **largest spa & thermal-water complex on the Balkans**, in nearby Banya — pools, saunas and mineral springs. A perfect free-time trip.

[Website](#) [Open in Google Maps](#)

Lake Okoto ("The Eye")

A breathtaking glacial "Eye" lake high in the mountains — one of Bulgaria's most beautiful lakes and a memorable hiking day-trip.

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Pirin National Park

UNESCO World Heritage site — mountain trails, alpine lakes and ancient pine forests, a short drive from Bansko.

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Bansko Gondola Lift

Ride up to Banderishka Polyana (1,100–1,700 m) for panoramic views — beautiful even in summer.

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Holy Trinity Church

Orthodox church built in 1835 with stunning frescoes, in the heart of Old Bansko.

[Open in Google Maps](#)

Bansko Old Town

Cobblestone streets, stone houses, cosy taverns (mehanas) and the pedestrian zone.

[Open in Google Maps](#)

What to Bring

Bansko in **August** is warm and sunny during the day (**22–28°C**) but can get cool in the evenings (**12–16°C**) due to the mountain altitude (~925 m). Pack layers!



Comfortable casual clothes



Light jacket / hoodie for evenings



Comfortable walking shoes



Flip-flops (for hotel spa & pool)



Swimming suit



Light rain jacket (just in case)



Sunglasses & sunscreen



Laptop or tablet (for group work)



Phone, charger & power adapter



Reusable bottle & cup (green project!)



Some cash (EUR)



Personal medication (if any)



ID card or passport & EHIC card



Snacks/food for Cultural Night

💡 Useful travel tips

- **Taxis in Bansko** are affordable — hail one at the bus station or call from reception. Always **keep receipts** for reimbursement.
- Check bus schedules and routes at obilet.com or use **Google Maps**.
- Most shops and restaurants accept **card payments**, but keep some cash for smaller places.
- **Tap water** is safe and delicious — it flows **directly from the Pirin Mountain springs**. Refill your reusable bottle instead of buying plastic!
- Bulgaria uses **Type C & F power plugs** (230V) — bring an adapter if yours differ.

Bulgaria Basics



Greetings

Здравей! (<i>Zdravey!</i>)	Hello
Добър ден (<i>Dobar den</i>)	Good afternoon
Довиждане (<i>Dovizhdane</i>)	Goodbye

Politeness

Моля (<i>Molya</i>)	Please
Благодаря (<i>Blagodarya</i>)	Thank you
Извинете (<i>Izvinete</i>)	Excuse me

Getting Around

Къде е...? (<i>Kade e...?</i>)	Where is...?
Колко струва? (<i>Kolko struva?</i>)	How much is it?
Говорите ли английски? (<i>Govorite li angliyski?</i>)	Do you speak English?

Useful Phrases

Да / Не (<i>Da / Ne</i>)	Yes / No
Наздраве! (<i>Nazdrave!</i>)	Cheers!

⚠ **Fun fact:** In Bulgaria, **nodding means "no"** and **shaking your head means "yes"** — the opposite of most countries!

Basic info for Bulgaria

LOCAL CURRENCY Euro (EUR) 🇪🇺	LANGUAGE Bulgarian
ALPHABET Cyrillic	TIME ZONE EET (GMT+2)
EMERGENCY NUMBER 112	POWER PLUG Type C / F (230V)

Contact Information

For any questions before or during the project, contact the project coordinator any time.

PROJECT COORDINATOR

Kristiyan

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 **erasmus@forumjugend.do**

 **Hotel reception (24/7): +359 899 106 931**



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